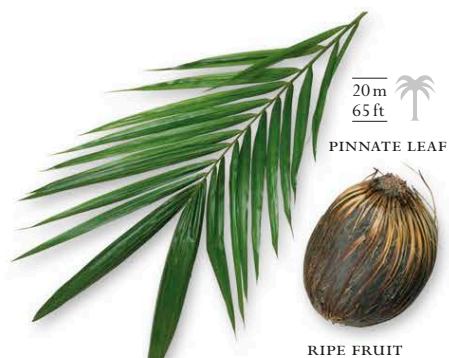




AFRICAN OIL PALM
Elaeis guineensis
F: Arecaceae

A plant of humid tropical lowlands, this palm is extensively cultivated beyond its native Africa for the oils contained in its fruits.



BOTTLE PALM
Hyophorbe lagenicaulis
F: Arecaceae

This swollen-based palm comes from tiny Round Island near Mauritius. It is widely grown as an ornamental.



15 m
50 ft

SAGO PALM
Metroxylon sagu
F: Arecaceae

Shown here as a young plant, this swamp-living palm probably originated in New Guinea but is now grown throughout S.E. Asia.



CHUSAN PALM
Trachycarpus fortunei
F: Arecaceae

From C. China, this cold-tolerant species has separate male and female plants. The females produce round, blue-black fruits.



30 m
100 ft



COCO DE MER
Lodoicea maldivica
F: Arecaceae

The seeds of this palm from the Seychelles are the biggest in the plant kingdom. They take six years to mature.

ROYAL PALM
Roystonea regia
F: Arecaceae

Often planted in stately avenues in the tropics, this handsome smooth-trunked species is native from C. America to Florida and Cuba.

25 m
80 ft

RAFFIA PALM
Raphia farinifera
F: Arecaceae

At 20 m (65 ft) long, the leaves of this African palm are the largest of any tree.

10 m
30 ft



20 m
65 ft

PALMYRA PALM
Borassus flabellifer
F: Arecaceae

This tall-trunked species from S. Asia favours drier habitats. It is cultivated for its fruits and sugar-yielding sap.



fan-shaped
leaf up to 1 m
(3¼ ft) across

3 m
10 ft

BRAZILIAN WAX PALM
Copernicia prunifera
F: Arecaceae

A waxy coating on the leaves of this palm from N.E. Brazil helps it resist drought. The harvested wax is used in polish and soap.



EUROPEAN FAN PALM
Chamaerops humilis
F: Arecaceae

Often trunkless in the wild, cultivated specimens grow several short trunks from a single base. It originates from Mediterranean countries.

25 m
80 ft



CHILEAN WINE PALM
Jubaea chilensis
F: Arecaceae

Also known as the coquito palm, this massive-trunked, cold-tolerant palm is native only to C. Chile, where it is now a protected species.